

FMAC RECRUITMENT TASK

1. CHARACTERS

Raghu- man, 26, investment banker, lives in mumbai, from small village in UP.

Shreenath- 33, branch manager, boss of Raghu, his father owns the firm.

Reena- rich woman, beautiful, 28, daughter of the owner of a rival firm.

Shekhar- works at Reena's firm, went to college with Raghu.

Vaishnavi- Raghu's deskmate, 29

Srimal- 67, owner of the firm.

2. SCENE: BOARD MEETING, VENKATRAMAN-LALJIBHAI FIRM, SHREENATH IS SITTING IN THE SEAT 3RD TO THE RIGHT OF HIS FATHER, PLAYING WITH A FIDGET SPINNER.

SRIMAL

For some reason I dont understand,
those retards down the street seem
to be making purchases we plan to
before we do.

(his hand presses against
his forehead)

I know for a fact they dont have
enough brains to out think us, so
it must mean someone is leaking
inside information out of our
system.

Looks around the room, glares at his son who is playing and not paying attention.

SHREENATH

S-sorry,
(continues after being
elbowed by the man next to
him)

I was paying attention, obviously.
And i agree with everything lord
father here has to say, we
definitely have a mole in our
syste, the only question is, who?

Everyone looks around the room, slightly confused but also with a newfound layer of suspicion.

Raghu isnt looking up or around, hes fixated on the numbers in front of him. A few moments later, people around began noticing that this one man is either not listening or doesnt care enough to react.

SHREENATH

Yo, Raghu, are you paying attention?

Raghu looks up from his tablet, nods.

Oh yeah? Then tell me what dad was talking about.

RAGHU

He said that the idiots down the street seem to have our data and are using it to dilute our profits, we might have a mole in our system. I heard loud and clear.

He went back into his work.

SRIMAL

Who do we think it might be?

He leans back on his chair, lifts a glass of water off the table and takes a sip.

SHREENATH

The question to the who can be answered only when you answer the question of why.

He looks at Raghu, who's still looking down disconnected from the conversation.

Why, after drawing such an amazing salary from our dear firm might someone sell out to our direct competition.

RAGHU

I dont know man, you dont really pay enough,

He says and laughs a bit without looking up.

But I dont think any sort of corporate mole at this level would do it for just the money, theres a lot of money in this world.

He looks up, smiles at shreenath and looks at his watch.

If theres nothing else to discuss, can I get back to work?

Looks at Shreenath as he stands up,

Some of us have to earn our living.

3. SCENE: RAGHU'S DESK. ITS A SMALL DESK, SHARED BY 2

Vaishnavi looks up from her pc, welcomes Raghu into the area with an exaggerated hand movement.

VAISHNAVI

O hail lord Raghu, 26 saal ke
bacche ko they will call in these
stupid meetings but not me.

The camera cuts to her degree stuck on the wall, she passed
out 3 years senior to Raghu.

What do you even do there dude? Up
in the exclusive club.

Raghu sits down in his chair, stretches out. He looks at his
deskmate, up and down. He looks very disinterested.

RAGHU

Talent. Talent mi amor. Plus these
things arent as alluring as you
seem to think for some reason,
theyre boring as shit. Too much
talking too little doing.

Opens his laptop and scribble pad.

Aaj they found a new useless topic
to waste an hour on. A MOLE. They
think someone is sending data over
beyond the loc. Crazy shit.

Begins typing something on his laptop, frowns.

Btw, nice purse, looks new.

VAISHNAVI

Thanks for noticing! And yes I mean
its possible. Im sure theres people
here who arent satisfied with their
job. Someone who needs money maybe.

She tries to look at Raghu's laptop screen, but he switches
tabs abruptly. She pretends to look away and back towards her
work.

4. SCENE: SHREENATH'S OFFICE

SRIMAL

Do you not understand the severity
of this situation you moron?

He walks up and down in frustration, shreenath is sitting in
his chair going through papers.

What are you even doing? Sitting in
your high chair looking at stuff,
doing nothing like a useless
animal.

Shreenath continues looking at the papers, seemingly ignoring
his father's words completely.

Oh my god, frickin look at me when
I'm talking to you.

Shreenath looks at his phone. Its a message from Reena Sharma.

SHREENATH

I dont know. I dont know who it is, or who it can be. No one in my knowledge has any contact with our dear neighbours. And i cant think of any reason as to why someone would sell out other than money.

He looked up, frustrated at his father's words.

SRIMAL

You dont know. YOU DONT KNOW! What a capable son I have. Do you think you were sent off to the US and given a job here so you can answer I dont know? You aren't even qualified to be in one of those cubicles,

He said pointing at a degree on the wall, throws it down.

You got here because i happen to be your father. You don't deserve to lead a team. But you know who does? Raghu. That boy is everything i wanted you to be my lord he is capable. He is polite. And he never uses words like I DONT KNOW. He should be in your seat.

Shreenath is getting more visibly angry, his nostrils flare and he clenches his jaw.

I want you to do your f** job and know your people, and tell me who it is, if not then trust me you will have no job left by the end of this week.

He storms out of the office, banging the door behind him. Shreenath pulls out a cigarette from his drawer and lights it.

SHREENATH

Raghu, Raghu, Raghu. RAGHU all the damn time that guy. Raghu this, Raghu that. Be like him, he's better. Do like him. Old ass man. Ill show him be like Raghu.

Pulls out raghu's employment record on his computer.

I dont even care if youre the one that srimal is looking for, but youe the one that he's gonna be presented with.

He scrolls. His eyes light up. He gets off the chair, picks up his shattered degree frame, props it back up. Grabs his bag and walks out of the office.

(camera pans to the screen)

Its the background check of Raghu.

His family finances and his native place.

5. SCENE: OFFICE END TIME. LEAVING TIME

Vaishnavi closes her laptop lid, the last thing visible on screen is 'Suresh Sharma' as recipient to a mail.

Everyone in the office leaves one by one. Vaishnavi looks into Raghu's computer as she leaves, its a hospital site open.

VAISHNAVI

I know youre dedicated but come on,
its time to leave.

He looks up, closes his laptop lid.

RAGHU

Yes I know. Im heading right out.
No need to wait.

Shreenath walks towards vaishnavi.

SHREENATH

Hello my favourite employee, its
been a while.

VAISHNAVI

Really? Favourite? You have
literally never talked to me
outside of work.

SHREENATH

Well im talking right now. How come
Raghu isnt here, arent you two a
thing?

VAISHNAVI

O hell no, no thing. Just
deskmates. He's already got a
thing. But no he said he'll head
out in a few.

SHREENATH

Have you ever walked out together,
do you know where he lives?

VAISHNAVI

Come to think of it, no. I actually havent seen his place, or see him leave the office. Maybe he crashes here.

SHREENATH

Interesting. Nice meeting you have a nice night. Tomorrow is a team lunch, my treat, no need to bring a tiffin or something.

He stood there watching, as vaishnavi walked out of the office.

Some time later Raghu walks out of the office. He goes to the two wheeler parking, Shreenath watches him from his stationary car.

He follows from a distance as Raghu makes turn after turn. After a point, the gulleys got so narrow that he had to ditch the car and follow on foot.

After some time, the scooter stopped, Raghu got off and put his helmet in the dicky.

SHREENATH

What the fuck is this place, I knoe for a fact that I pay him way more than he would need to get out of this shit hole. Why would a 26 year old bachelor live in this dump. What woman would wanna come here.

He jumps a bit as a rat races across the street.
Eugh. Disgusting.

He follows again. Tip toes up the staircase maintaining his presence in a blind spot.

The walls are like that of an old building. With green growing on the edges and cobwebs in the corners.

Raghu gets a call.

RAGHU

Yes, i'm literally at the doorstep my god be a bit patient. I have no where else to go.

He puts the phone back in his pocket as he approaches the door.

Thud. The door shuts behind him.

Shreenath looks at the door, very unassuming. Basic poor person house type door. Old school. Looks down.

Sees a pair of heels. Is intrigued. Picks one up. Its a stuart weitzmann heel.

SHREENATH

What the hell. This seems a bit out of league for little raghu. Eh, might be fake.

He puts it down. Tries looking in from the little window beside the door.

Sees two familiar faces instead of one.

Raghu and Reena sharma. Ew. Ew. My eyes, my eyes. What is she doing with hi- UGH.

He steps back from the 'amorous' visual. Took a deep breath. Opened his phone, navigated to his chat with Reena.

'm so sorry, busy 2nite w work, lets meet tmr for dinner, pick a nice restro'

So this is work now.

He's angry. Shreenath under the assumption that he's been having the undercover thing with the enemy is now enraged.

His 'girlfriend' was hooking up with a lowly employee in an apartment he wouldnt even know existed if he didnt completely despise raghu.

Take me to a nice place. Ew look at that. No i only like high end shit.

He said imitating Reena's voice. And now he watched her in a literal dump.

He runs out, angry, disgusted, looks betrayed. Slips a bit on the stairs. His pocketsquare falls out on the way.

6. SCENE: INSIDE RAGHU'S HOUSE

Raghu is sitting up when he sees Reena's phone buzz.

She is standing a bit far away drinking water.

Out of curiosity due to the incessant buzzing, he takes a peek at the screen.

'what the hell are you doing. I thought i have given you enough' among 10 other texts flashed before his eyes.

RAGHU

Huh, Shreenath. Mr theres a mole in our institution here 'giving' things to miss enemy? What business does this guy even have with her?

(softly under his breath)

Reena walks back to him, picks up her purse and reaches for the phone.

Raghu doesnt say anything.

REENA

So, I'm gonna go now, this was great. Feels like colluding with the enemy. Haha, anyways, bye.

She walks out the door, puts her heels back on and leaves.

7. SCENE: MORNING AT RAGHU'S BUILDING

He walks out, dressed and showered. On the way to the scooter he sees a shiny piece of cloth on the stairs.

RAGHU

(to himself)

My god that guy followed me all the way here that is insane.

He takes the pocket square, puts it in his pocket and rides off towards the office.

8. SCENE: OFFICE

Raghu walks into his cubicle, everyone else is already in. He is a bit late.

VAISHNAVI

Looks like someone had a loong night Mr talent.

He looks him up and down, his hair are roughed and he looks tired.

Raghu says nothing, takes his seat, opens his laptop.

RAGHU

Good morning, how's your progress on the report? You have to send it in tomorrow.

(monotonously, completely ignoring her comment)

Vaishnavi looks slightly offended.

VAISHNAVI

Oh come on man, we've been sitting together for so long. I know you text the same woman secretly everyday, you dont have to pretend that you sneak off every night.

He looks up, slightly annoyed.

RAGHU

First of all, none of your business. Second of all you're here to work, not pry into my night life. Keep this up and you'll never be invited to these meetings you seem so interested in.

Gets back to work.

Vaishnavi gets off the chair and walks out.

She walks to Shreenath's office.

SHREENATH

Well hello Vishaka-

VAISHNAVI

Vaishnavi.

SHREENATH

Yes, right. Vaishnavi. Sorry, my mind is a bit foggy right now, I had a long night. Anyway, yes what do you want? The retail report I asked of you? Is that done?

She walks in, closes the door behind her.

VAISHNAVI

No, I mean yes its almost done but thats not why I'm here. You know yesterday you asked me regarding where Raghu disappears to, and I said I dont know. Well I do,

He points her to a chair, gestures to sit.

SHREENATH

Yes please.

VAISHNAVI

He sneaks off every other night to meet a woman. Someone he's hooking up with.

SHREENATH

Seriously? That's your big reveal?
I dont care about who he sleeps
with.

VAISHNAVI

But you should. Its Reena Sharma.

Shreenath pretends to be surprised.

SHREENATH

No way. Thats insane. Thats the
enemy. I dont believe it. Raghu?
But he's my father's favourite.

VAISHNAVI

Yes exactly. Raghu. The same guy
you people keep in your meetings
and inner discussions because he's
apparently gifted with numbers or
something.

SHREENATH

But what reason could he possibly
have. He doesnt look like the type
to be swayed by emotions or fall
into honey traps.

VAISHNAVI

Well, yeah. I know that. I've sat
with him for 2 years now. Maybe not
a trap, but desperation.

SHREENATH

Are you talking about his father's
brain surgery?

He makes an attempt at looking concerned.

VAISHNAVI

Yes. I mean I know him, hes a great
guy. Never in his right mind would
he do something like this, but when
it comes to money, desperation can
get the best of us. And its not
like you people pay him much.

SHREENATH

Thank you so much for this
information, VAISHNAVI. You're my
favourite have I told you that?
I'll look into this matter no
worries.

He gestures to the door.

You can get back to work.

9. SCENE: CUBICLE

Vaishnavi walks back in.

Sits back in her chair.

Gets back to work.

VAISHNAVI

Aren't you gonna ask me where I
was?

Raghu looks up, moves his head sideways. Looks back down.

VAISHNAVI

What the hell? I work with you
every day, and you don't even care
enough to ask where I went clearly
looking pissed.

He looks up, he looks sleepy.

Well just so you know, I went to
Shreenath, I told him all about
your little thing with Reena
Sharma. How I think you might be
the mole.

Now he looks interested. Concerned.

RAGHU

Are you fricking kidding me? I
don't talk right one time cause I'm
sleepy and you go to the boss's kid
and squeal about a thing youre not
even sure about that could
implicate me and ruin my entire
life?

He looks angry. Vaishnavi sort of seems to realise that she
might have made a mistake.

My god you are so. I dont even know
what to say. Yes, youre right I do
meet Reena but its not to exchange
company data, its just something
that happened. Between my dad's
bills and work I dont even know how
this happened but it made one part
of my day worth looking forward to.
This is going to cost me my job.

VAISHNAVI

I am so-

RAGHU

Sorry? Yeah you better be. If it was just me I wouldnt have cared but my job has my parents' lives attached to it.

He shuts the laptop lid hard. Grabs his hair and leans back on the chair.

VAISHNAVI

I am so sorry genuinely. Sneaking off into the night with a person like her doesnt exactly scream innocent. I've known for some time about you, but I kept shush. This time I got pissed and thought you actually might be the, you know.

RAGHU

Well then talk to me first? Shreenath has some covert conversation with Reena going on too. I saw his texts on her phone last night. With words like have i not given you enough. "GIVEN" doesnt that sound like hes leaking data. You literally went and told probably the actual mole about things that implicate me. That is so stupid. Between me, a poor guy strapped for cash and the literal son of the boss, obviously I'm the one getting axed.

He puts his head down. Vaishnavi seems concerned and her face looks like she's regretting her actions.

VAISHNAVI

I mean, they're just words, I can take them back. I'll say it was some other Reena and that i just assumed because i was angry at you. Its my word against mine. Its fine. Dont worry.

She gets up and tries to comfort him with a hug. A voice says in the background.

ROHIT(THE GUY IN THE NEXT CUBICLE)

Raghu, bossman Srimal is calling you to his office. Looks like your promotion is here.

ROHIT

Shit, shit, shit. Okay, its fine, its fine.

He gets off his chair, grabs the water bottle and chugs.

He walks out, trying to look calm and composed. Passes all the cubicles and offices before walking to the big one at the end of the corridor.

10. SCENE: SRIMAL'S OFFICE

Raghu walks in, nods at Srimal. Looks sideways to see Shreenath grinning and turns back straight.

SRIMAL

I will just get to the point, no need beating around the bush. My boy here says you are the leak. I don't want to believe him, i like you a lot. But he has presented some irrefutable evidence regarding your collusion with people from that firm. What do you have to say for yourself.

Raghu gulps down, clears his throat.

RAGHU

Sir, I dont deny the allegations of having an affair with miss Reena. Those are true. I'm sure whatever proof you have is perfectly correct. But i will deny the allegations of being the leak. I love this company with all my heart. You have given me opportunity to make something of myself and support my family, why would i bite the hand that feeds me?

SHREENATH

Seriously dude? You expect us to believe that the only thing you're sharing with Reena is your time and energy? She's not helping you pay your father's hospital bills and your parents' home loans using her massive pockets in exchange for sensitive company data?

Raghu looks at Srimal, then towards Shreenath.

RAGHU

Yes, I do. I am not lying. I have recieved no money, nor have I given out any data to her.

(MORE)

RAGHU (CONT'D)

If I was getting money from her,
why in the world would I be living
in the dump you saw yourself
yesterday. I make more than enough
to live in a much nicer area.

SRIMAL

Its not easy to believe you right
now Raghu, especially with the fact
that you definitely have a relation
with the Sharma girl.

Raghu looks around, his feet and tapping the ground
aggressively.

RAGHU

Sir, if my relation with miss Reena
is taken against my case, then the
same should be applicable to your
son. I have proof that he has
contact with Reena Sharma over
text. Here, see.

He shows him the picture he took of Shreenath's text from the
night before.

Is that any way to talk to the
enemy? What do you think he has
given her that she doesn't have
already.

Shreenath looks pissed and glares at Raghu.

RAGHU

If anything, him being the boss
conversing with people like her
shows that its actually him who's
sending our data to them. Just
think about it sir.

SHREENATH

What possible reason can I have to
send company data to her. You have
the reason of financial
desperation, I dont. Its not like
im romantically involved either,
cause thats you too.

RAGHU

Oh come on. Everyone knows your
father, no offence sir, has only
given you this job because youre
his child. You dont deserve it and
he's made it clear to your face
that he thinks i'm better than you.

(MORE)

RAGHU (CONT'D)

All you get from this company and sir Srimal is daily scoldings and back handed insults. I would get fed up, as you seemingly have.

He looks at Srimal.

Its not hard to manipulate someone so devoid of affection in his life. He dislikes you, this company, this office, me and everyone here. Why wouldn't he send our data to them?

He holds out the pocketsquare.

He even followed me back home before he knew about my involvement with Reena in order to throw me under the bus.

Drops the pocketsquare on the table.

Who looks more guilty now?

A small giggle sound from outside the door prompts Shreenath to open it.

Vaishnavi was looking into the office eavsdropping on the 3 men inside.

SRIMAL

Who are you? Did I call her here?

RAGHU

This is vai-

VAISHNAVI

I'm vaishnavi, Raghu's desk mate. I have been working at this company for 3 years longer than him, but its fine you wouldn't know that. And no you didn't call me here. But then again, you never do.

The door slowly slides back into place. Srimal looks confused.

SRIMAL

I don't see how that's relevant here. We are having an important discussion about something. Your grievances regarding lack of attention will be adressed later.

Srimal turns back towards Shreenath and Raghu.

VAISHNAVI

See thats the problem. You don't even know I exist. I could sell your entire company out to anyone and you wouldn't care because you dont even know i work for you. Sometimes its who are you, sometimes its vishaka. Come on! It can not possibly be that hard.

Srimal ignores her.

SRIMAL

So, both of you idiots. Both of you involved with the wrong people. Both of you equally blamable...

VAISHNAVI

How the hell do you even pretend im not here. Can YOU NOT HERE ME???

She slams a file on the desk. Everyone is now looking at her. I. Ich. Me. I am the one sending information to the Sharmas. Happy?

SHREENATH

This isn't the time for jokes
Vishaka, we'll talk over lunch.
This is important.

Vaishnavi looks angry. Raghu is lookig at the ground. He looks like he's muttering prayers to gods to save his job.

VAISHNAVI

ITS VAISHNAVI. You people have no shame. I am telling you to your face I AM THE LEAK. How do you refuse to acknowledge this.

SRIMAL

No way. If you were important enough to know things worth leaking, I'd know your name.

VAISHNAVI

I have my ways. See I really thought that maybe my hard works goes under the radar, but this. This would definitely stir something up, but no. It seems like whatever I do, I will always remain invisible here.

In a fit of rage, she picks up a pencil and runs toward Srimal.

Raghu grabs her from the back.

RAGHU

Calm down! Dude shh. Easy. You dont wanna do this.

They keep struggling.

VAISHNAVI

NO I DO. LET. ME. GO. Do you know how many hours and years i have given to this place? And what have I gotten in return? NOTHING! These people dont even know my name!!

Shreenath joined in, pulls the pencil out of her hand.

SRIMAL

This woman is crazy! Get her out of my office!

SHREENATH

Oh you shut up old man!

He turns to vaishnavi.

Calm down, sit down, its fine.

He calls the peon to get some water.

VAISHNAVI

You know those people are so much better than you. They treat me like i am someone. I have respect there. I get paid so much more than here.

SRIMAL

Yeah well obviously they'll respect you, you sell them stolen data. You are their source of income.

RAGHU

I really think you should maybe stop talking.

Vaishnavi drinks the water. Calms down a bit.

SHREENATH

Now that we've established who the leak is, you are obviously fired.

He says this in a joking manner.

No but fr, you are definitely fired.

Vaishnavi jumps off the chair.

Punches Shreenath in the face. His nose bleeds a bit.

VAISHNAVI

Consider this my resignation. Oh
and by the way..

Gives middle finger to Shreenath and Srimal. And walks out of
the office.

RAGHU

Do I still get to keep my job? I
swear i wont talk to Reena again.

Chuckles. Srimal and Shreenath also chuckle.

Shreenath looks at his father.

SHREENATH

Maybe I shouldve let her puncture
you. Then all this shit would be
mine. `

They walk back to each of their offices

11. SCENE: REENA'S OFFICE

She is sitting on the chair, looking at her laptop.

An email from S. Venkatraman.

'They dont suspect a thing.'